Lessons

Triangles

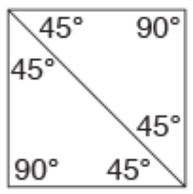
Toolbox

Triangles

A **triangle** is a polygon with three sides.

- The sum of the angles in a triangle is 180°.

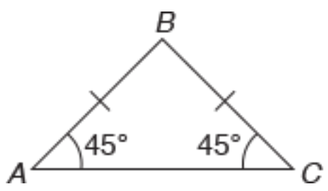
To see this, draw a diagonal through a square. The square is divided into two equal triangles. Notice that the diagonal divides two of the right angles in half. The sum of the three angles in either of the triangles is 45° + 45° + 90° = 180°.



$90^\circ + 45^\circ + 45^\circ = 180^\circ$

- Equal sides are opposite equal angles.

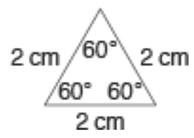
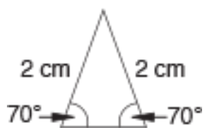
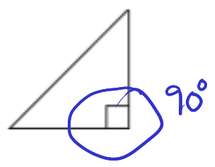
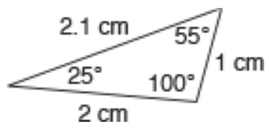
In the triangle ABC, $\angle A$ and $\angle C$ are equal. Both measure 45°. The sides across from them, AB and BC, are also equal.



- The longest side is opposite the largest angle.

In triangle ABC, $\angle B$ is the largest angle. The side across from it, side AC, is the longest side.

The names of the triangles come from the relationships among the angles and the sides.

Name	Properties	Examples
equilateral	three equal sides three equal angles	
isosceles	two equal sides two equal angles	
right	one right angle	
scalene	no equal sides no equal angles	

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